

**Parkinson's Disease (DC 8004)** Minimum evaluation 30%; Use suggested diagnostic codes below when evaluating manifestations of Parkinson's disease beyond the minimum. Choose diagnostic code(s) that most nearly approximates the disability(ies) shown.

| Manifestation                                                                                                                                                        | Suggested DC                                                                                                                                                    | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stooped posture                                                                                                                                                      | 8211                                                                                                                                                            | Separate evaluations warranted for left side and right side involvement; bilateral factor does not apply                                                                                                            |
| Balance impairment                                                                                                                                                   | 6204                                                                                                                                                            | For use when balance impairment is present without lower extremity impairment. Otherwise, consider balance impairment as part of extremity evaluation [shown below]                                                 |
| Bradykinesia or slowed motion                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                 | Consider as part of extremity evaluations                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Loss of automatic movements (face masking, drooling, etc)                                                                                                            | 8207                                                                                                                                                            | Separate evaluations warranted for left side and right-side involvement; bilateral factor does not apply                                                                                                            |
| Speech changes                                                                                                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>8210 bilaterally,</li> <li>6516, or</li> <li>6519</li> </ul>                                                             | Any of these three DCs can be used. Assign whichever results in the highest evaluation. Bear in mind, cranial nerves are rated bilaterally.                                                                         |
| Upper extremity <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>tremors</li> <li>muscle rigidity</li> <li>stiffness, and/or</li> <li>bradykinesia or slowed motion</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>8514 for impairment without loss of use</li> <li>5125 for LOU of one hand</li> <li>5109 for LOU of both hands</li> </ul> | Loss of use is defined in 38 CFR 3.350(a)(2)                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Lower extremity <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>tremors</li> <li>muscle rigidity</li> <li>stiffness, and/or</li> <li>bradykinesia or slowed motion</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>8520 for impairment without LOU</li> <li>5167 for LOU of one foot</li> <li>5110 for LOU of both feet</li> </ul>          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Depression                                                                                                                                                           | 9434                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Cognitive impairment or Dementia                                                                                                                                     | 9326                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Loss of sense of smell                                                                                                                                               | 6275                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Sleep disturbance                                                                                                                                                    | if manifested as a <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>respiratory disability, 6847</li> <li>insomnia, 9410</li> </ul>                                       | If another mental disorders diagnosis is also present along with insomnia, evaluate insomnia along with the other mental disorder diagnoses. For more information on evaluating insomnia, see M21-1 III.iv.4.O.1.l. |
| Difficulty chewing/swallowing                                                                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>7203, or</li> <li>8205</li> </ul>                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Urinary problems                                                                                                                                                     | 7542                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Constipation                                                                                                                                                         | 7319                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Sexual dysfunction/ erectile Dysfunction                                                                                                                             | 7522                                                                                                                                                            | When associated to Parkinson's Disease diagnosis, grant SMC K, see M21-1 III.iv.4.I.3.b.                                                                                                                            |

**Multiple Sclerosis - (DC 8018)** Minimum evaluation 30%; Use suggested diagnostic codes provided below when evaluating manifestations of MS beyond the minimum. Choose diagnostic code(s) that most nearly approximates the disability(ies) shown.

| Manifestation                                                             | Suggested DC                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Speech difficulties, including hoarseness                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>6519</li> <li>6516</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Paralysis of soft pallet with swallowing difficulty and speech impairment | 6521                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Swallowing difficulties                                                   | 7203                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Respiratory conditions                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | If present, respiratory DBQ should be of record. Based on symptoms shown, select the most advantageous DC from 38 CFR 4.97 Schedule of ratings - Respiratory system                                                                                                                                      |
| Sleep disturbances                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>6847 - for sleep apnea or sleep apnea-like symptoms</li> <li>9410 - for insomnia</li> </ul>                                                                                                                      | If another mental disorders diagnosis is also present along with insomnia, evaluate insomnia along with the other mental disorders diagnosis.                                                                                                                                                            |
| Loss of sphincter control with or without leakage                         | 7332                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Chronic constipation                                                      | 7319                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Voiding dysfunction                                                       | 7542 for leakage, frequency, or obstructed voiding                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Only a single evaluation is warranted even if more than one dysfunction / symptom type is present. May be presented as symptoms only, versus an official diagnosis.                                                                                                                                      |
| Recurrent urinary tract infections                                        | 7527                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Erectile dysfunction                                                      | 7522                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | When associated to Multiple Sclerosis (MS) diagnosis, grant SMC K, see M21-1 III.iv.4.I.3.b.                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Visual disturbances                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>6090 - Diplopia or internuclear ophthalmoplegia</li> <li>6066 - decreased visual acuity or blurring of vision</li> <li>6081 - visual scotoma</li> <li>6016 - Nystagmus</li> <li>6026 - Optic neuritis</li> </ul> | For visual impairment, a single evaluation is warranted either under the general rating formula, OR based on visual impairment criteria (consisting of visual acuity, visual field, and impairment of muscle function)                                                                                   |
| Upper extremity(ies)                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>8514 for impairment without loss of use (LOU); separate evaluations warranted for bilateral involvement</li> <li>5125 for LOU of one hand</li> <li>5109 for LOU of both hands</li> </ul>                         | <p>Synthesize findings of neurologic exam (gait strength, deep tendon reflexes, sensation, muscle atrophy / weakness) and remaining effective function to assess level of impairment for the upper extremity, to include whether loss of use is present.</p> <p>LOU is defined in 38 CFR 3.350(a)(2)</p> |

**Multiple Sclerosis - (DC 8018)** Minimum evaluation 30%; Use suggested diagnostic codes provided below when evaluating manifestations of MS beyond the minimum. Choose diagnostic code(s) that most nearly approximates the disability(ies) shown.

|                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lower extremity(ies)             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• 8520 for impairment without LOU; separate evaluations warranted for bilateral involvement</li><li>• 5167 for LOU of one foot</li><li>• 5110 for LOU of both feet</li></ul> | Synthesize findings of neurologic exam (gait, strength, deep tendon reflexes, sensation, muscle atrophy / weakness) and remaining effective function to assess level of impairment for the lower extremity, to include whether loss of use is present.<br><br>LOU is defined in 38 CFR 3.350(a)(2) |
| Depression                       | 9434                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Cognitive impairment or Dementia | 9326                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

**Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis - (DC 8017)** Minimum evaluation 100%; Use suggested diagnostic codes provided below when evaluating manifestations of ALS beyond the minimum. Choose diagnostic code(s) that most nearly approximates the disability(ies) shown.

| Manifestation                                                             | Suggested DC                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Speech difficulties, including hoarseness                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>6519,</li> <li>6516, or</li> <li>8210 (assign two evaluations; left and right tenth cranial nerve)</li> </ul>                                                                            | Select evaluation criteria that provides the most advantageous evaluation.                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Paralysis of soft pallet with swallowing difficulty and speech impairment | 6521                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Swallowing difficulties                                                   | 7203                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Respiratory conditions (including requirement for tracheostomy)           | 6520                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | If present, PFT results should be of record.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Sleep apnea or sleep apnea-like condition                                 | 6847                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Loss of sphincter control with or without leakage                         | 7332                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Chronic constipation                                                      | 7319                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Voiding dysfunction                                                       | 7542 for leakage, frequency, or obstructed voiding                                                                                                                                                                              | Only a single evaluation is warranted, even if more than one dysfunction / symptom type is present. May be presented as symptoms only, versus an official diagnosis.                                                                                                                          |
| Recurrent urinary tract infections                                        | 7527                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Erectile dysfunction                                                      | 7522                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | When associated to (ALS) diagnosis, grant SMC K, see M21-1 III.iv.4.I.3.b.                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Upper extremity(ies)                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>8513 for impairment without loss of use (LOU); separate evaluations warranted for bilateral involvement</li> <li>5125 for LOU of one hand</li> <li>5109 for LOU of both hands</li> </ul> | <p>Synthesize findings of neurologic exam (gait, strength, reflexes, muscle weakness / atrophy) and remaining effective function to assess level of impairment for the upper extremity, to include whether loss of use is present.</p> <p>LOU is defined in 38 CFR 3.350(a)(2)</p>            |
| Lower extremity(ies)                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>8520 for impairment without LOU; separate evaluations warranted for bilateral involvement</li> <li>5167 for LOU of one foot</li> <li>5110 for LOU of both feet</li> </ul>                | <p>Synthesize findings of neurologic exam (gait, strength, reflexes, sensation, muscle atrophy / weakness) and remaining effective function to assess level of impairment for the lower extremity, to include whether loss of use is present.</p> <p>LOU is defined in 38 CFR 3.350(a)(2)</p> |
| Depression                                                                | 9434                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Cognitive impairment or Dementia                                          | 9326                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |